



Cybersecurity Frameworks — Cheat Sheet

Quick reference guide · Policies, Guidelines & Standards



The Three Pillars

Policy	Mandatory rules enforced by authority. Non-compliance = consequences.
Guideline	Recommended best practices. Flexible, adaptable to context.
Standard	Specific, measurable technical requirements. Often industry-defined.



ISO 27001

What it is	International ISMS certification standard
Who it's for	Large enterprises needing global recognition
Key output	Formal ISO 27001 certification
Complexity	High



NIST CSF 2.0

What it is	Flexible risk-based cybersecurity framework
5 Functions	Identify · Protect · Detect · Respond · Recover
Who it's for	US agencies, critical infrastructure, any org
Complexity	Medium



CIS Controls v8

What it is	18 prioritized, actionable security controls
IG1 (Basic)	Controls 1-6 — essential cyber hygiene for all
Who it's for	SMBs, teams starting their security journey
Complexity	Low-Medium



Key Takeaways

Start here	CIS Controls IG1 — quick wins, immediate impact
Scale up	NIST CSF — risk-based, strategic alignment
Go global	ISO 27001 — for formal international certification